

Supplier Partnership Review 2025

Annual assessment of key supply relationships · Confidential

OVERVIEW

Northwind Traders sources products from 29 suppliers across 12 countries. This review assesses the eight most strategically significant suppliers in fiscal year 2025, collectively representing approximately 76% of product cost of goods. Suppliers are rated on delivery reliability, product quality, pricing competitiveness, and relationship quality (1–5 scale).

Overall supplier performance improved in 2025 versus the prior period. The principal concern is Tokyo Traders (Tokyo, Japan), whose two late deliveries in Q2 2025 disrupted Northwind Traders' Seafood and Produce category availability for approximately six weeks. A formal supplier improvement plan was agreed with Tokyo Traders in August 2025.

SUPPLIER RATINGS SUMMARY — 2025

Supplier	Country	Categories	On-time	Quality	Rating
Exotic Liquids	UK	Beverages	100%	Excellent	5 / 5
Plutzer LM AG	Germany	Meat, Beverages	98%	Excellent	5 / 5
Specialty Biscuits Ltd	UK	Confections	97%	Good	4 / 5
Forêts d'érables	Canada	Condiments	96%	Good	4 / 5
Pavlova Ltd	Australia	Meat, Confections	94%	Good	4 / 5
New England Seafood C.	USA	Seafood	93%	Good	4 / 5
New Orleans Cajun D.	USA	Condiments	92%	Acceptable	3 / 5
Tokyo Traders	Japan	Meat, Produce	74%	Acceptable	2 / 5

DETAILED SUPPLIER NOTES

Exotic Liquids (London, United Kingdom)

Exotic Liquids has been a Northwind Traders Beverages supplier since the company's founding and achieved a perfect 100% on-time delivery rate across all 2025 shipments. All deliveries met or exceeded product quality specifications. The 2026 supply contract is under negotiation; Exotic Liquids has indicated a 3–5% price increase on premium lines (Côte de Blaye and Chartreuse verte) reflecting European input cost pressures. Northwind Traders purchasing team recommendation: renew on standard annual review terms.

Plutzer Lebensmittelgroßmärkte AG (Frankfurt, Germany)

Plutzer Lebensmittelgroßmärkte AG supplies five Northwind Traders product lines across Meat/Poultry and Beverages categories, two of which rank in the company's top-ten products by volume. Plutzer achieved 98% on-time delivery in 2025 and has proposed a joint promotional campaign for the German retail channel in Q2 2026. Northwind Traders classifies Plutzer as a strategic supplier; the relationship is managed at VP level by Andrew Fuller.

Tokyo Traders (Tokyo, Japan) — Under Supplier Improvement Plan

Tokyo Traders supplies Northwind Traders with two Produce/Meat product lines: Tofu (product #14) and Konbu (product #13). In Q2 2025, Tofu delivery was delayed 18 days (May 2025) and Konbu arrived 12 days late (June 2025). The combined revenue impact was \$6,840 and generated one formal customer complaint from Hanari Carnes (Rio de Janeiro, Brazil). A corrective action plan signed in August 2025 requires 30-day advance shipment notification and includes a financial penalty for delays exceeding 10 days. Mayumi's (Osaka, Japan) has been pre-qualified as a contingency Produce supplier. Tokyo Traders' on-time rate from September to December 2025 was 75% (3 of 4 shipments on schedule).

Forêts d'érables (Ste-Hyacinthe, Canada)

Forêts d'érables has shown consistent improvement over three consecutive years. Two new Northwind Traders product lines — Sirop d'érable (product #61) and Tarte au sucre (product #65) — were added to the portfolio in H2 2025, both achieving positive initial sell-through. Forêts d'érables is under consideration for preferred partner status in 2026, which would include priority allocation agreements and extended payment terms.

New England Seafood Cannery (Boston, USA) — New Supplier

New England Seafood Cannery was qualified as a contingency Seafood supplier in July 2025 following the Tokyo Traders disruption. Four shipments were completed between July and December 2025 with a 93% on-time rate and no quality complaints. Volume is expected to increase in 2026 as additional Seafood product lines are qualified through New England Seafood Cannery.

Prepared by: Purchasing Department · Northwind Traders · January 2026